48. SELinux/AppArmor Awareness

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Phase: Phase 9 — Security and SSH
Estimated time: 1–2 days
Slug: `48-selinux-apparmor`

Learning objectives

- Know which MAC system your distro uses
- Read basic denials from logs
- Avoid setenforce 0 as permanent fix
- Apply targeted policy changes properly

Prerequisites

Complete prior numbered lessons. Prefer a real Linux VM/container for Linux-specific topics.

Mandatory Access Control (MAC) confines processes beyond chmod.

- RHEL family: SELinux
- Ubuntu: AppArmor

```
getenforce            # SELinux
sudo aa-status        # AppArmor
```

If a service fails only when confined, fix the policy — do not permanently disable MAC on prod.

Common mistakes

- setenforce 0 forever
- Disabling AppArmor globally
- Ignoring AVC denial logs

Exercises

Work in `exercises/48-selinux-apparmor/`. Run:

```
./test.sh
```

- **A (Drill):** make `./test.sh` pass
- **B (Apply):** note one real command you ran on a Linux host related to this lesson
- **C (Challenge):** rewrite your solution from memory the next day

Do not open `solutions/48-selinux-apparmor/` until you have an honest failing attempt.

Self-check

1. SELinux vs AppArmor typical distros?

2. Why not disable MAC?
3. Where see denials?

Further reading

- https://www.selinuxproject.org/page/Main_Page